

Sarah A. Al Falatah, ABD

Curriculum Vitae

(Updated April 2026)

School of Criminology and Criminal Justice
University of Nebraska Omaha
6001 Dodge Street; CPACS 218
Omaha, NE 68123

Email: Salfalatah@unomaha.edu

Web: [Google Scholar](#), [LinkedIn](#)

EDUCATION

- Spring 2027 *Expected* **Ph.D.** Criminology and Criminal Justice, *University of Nebraska at Omaha*
Chair: Dr. Tara Richards
- 2023 **M.A.** Criminology and Criminal Justice, *University of Nebraska at Omaha*
Thesis: “*The Implications of the COVID-19 Pandemic on Attempted Suicide Calls for Police Service and Underlying Context for Suicide Attempt Survivors*”
Committee: Drs. Sadaf Hashimi (Chair), Justin Nix, and Mario Scalora
- 2021 **B.S.** Biomedical Science (*cum laude*), *University of South Florida*
Minor: Criminology

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Mental Health, Physical Health, Suicide, Program Evaluation, Rehabilitation

PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES (ORCID: [0009-0009-9349-1913](https://orcid.org/0009-0009-9349-1913))

- 2025 Vietto, N., Armstrong, T., Schroll, D., and **Al Falatah, S.** Differences in Associations Between Autonomic Nervous System Activity and Psychopathic Traits Across Stress Paradigms and Measures. *Psychopathology and Behavioral Assessment* 47(1), 1-12. [[article link](#)]

RESEARCH REPORTS

- 2025 Campagna, M., Spohn, R., Hamilton, Z., **Al Falatah, S.**, Ursino, J., Gildea, B., Tostlebe, J., Hayes, A., & Towne, K. (2024). *Evaluation Report: Anger Management Program at the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha. [[report link](#)]

- 2024 Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., Kigerl, A., Kobie, A., and **Al Falatah, A.** *The Iowa risk & needs assessment evaluation and development: Iowa Board of Parole.* Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha.
- Campagna, M., Towne, K., Spohn, R., Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., Krushas, A., Gildea, B., Ursino, J., **Al Falatah, S.**, and Hayes, A. *Evaluation Report: Violence Reduction Program at the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services.* Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha. [[report link](#)]
- 2023 **Al Falatah, S.** Hashimi, S. *The implications of the COVID-19 pandemic on attempted suicide trends.* Omaha Police Department.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2026 - Current *ENCOMPASS (Engaging Networks within the Community of Omaha to Maintain and Promote a Safe Society)*, University of Nebraska Omaha
- Funding: Funded by Bureau of Justice Assistance Award #15PBJA-24-GG-03108-CVIP
- Role: **Graduate Research Assistant** (Drs. Tara Richards & Lane Gillespie)
- Evaluating the effectiveness of ENCOMPASS
 - Conducting a scoping review on hospital-based violence intervention programs
 - Collecting data on criminal justice outcomes through Nebraska Justice Search
- 2025 – 2026 *Nebraska Department of Correctional Services (NDCS) Internship—post-traumatic growth among incarcerated people*, University of Nebraska Omaha
- Role: **Graduate Research Assistant** (Dr. Zachary Hamilton)
- Coded 12 qualitative interviews in MAXQDA
 - Contributed to the write-up of the qualitative findings
- 2023 – 2026 *Evaluation of Clinical and Non-Clinical Programs at the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services (NDCS)*, University of Nebraska Omaha
- Funding: Funded by NDCS for \$852,475
- Role: **Graduate Research Assistant** (Drs. Ryan Spohn & Zachary Hamilton)
- Assisted with technical report writing
 - Completed 6 interviews with NDCS staff
 - Completed 4 interviews with participants
 - Conducted consensus qualitative coding for staff and participant interviews
- 2022 –2023 *Behavioral Health and Wellness Unit Internship*, Omaha Police Department

- Role: Graduate Research Assistant (Dr. Sadaf Hashimi)**
- Reviewed all incident reports (i.e., overdose, injury, sickness, and suicide attempt) at Omaha Police Department (OPD)
 - Reclassified incident reports as suicide attempts based on criteria established with OPD
 - Built a suicide attempt database for OPD detailing characteristics of suicide attempters and the suicide attempt incidents
- 2021 – 2022 *Screening for Insider Threats in US Law Enforcement*, University of Nebraska Omaha
- Funding:** Funded by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security for \$135,785
- Role: Graduate Research Assistant (Drs. Erin Kearns & Sadaf Hashimi)**
- Collected data from police department websites on recruiting practices
 - Assisted with creating a database on policing hiring practices (incentives, disincentives, and safety prevention measures)
 - Conducted intercoder reliability checks
- 2021 – 2022 *Autonomic Nervous System Reactivity and Antisocial Behavior*, University of Nebraska at Omaha
- Role: Graduate Research Assistant (Dr. Todd Armstrong)**
- Assisted with data collection (survey responses and physiological data)
 - Assisted with cleaning and coding the data for analyses
- 2019 – 2021 *Mental Health Facilities Treatment; Psychological Assessment of Risk and Criminality (PARC) with Pasco County Sheriff's Office*, University of South Florida
- Role: Undergraduate & Graduate Research Assistant (Dr. Bryanna Fox)**
- Assisted with data cleaning and coding for multiple projects
 - Assisted with building a database on white-collar crime in the U.S.
- 2019 – 2021 *Social Preferences and Environmental Behavior*, University of South Florida
- Role: Undergraduate Research Assistant (Dr. Chae Jaynes)**
- Assisted with survey development and distribution
 - Assisted with cleaning and coding data in Stata

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 **Al Falatah, S.** The Role of Co-Occurring Mental Health, Physical Health, and Substance Use on Youth Arrest. The Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences, *Philadelphia Conference*. [poster]
- 2025 **Al Falatah, S.** The Role of Co-Occurring Mental Health, Physical Health, and Substance Use on Criminal Behavior. The American Society of Criminology, *DC Conference*. [manuscript in progress]
- *Did not attend due to the government shutdown*

- 2024 **Al Falatah, S.**, Tostlebe, J., & Hashimi, S. How do mental health concerns impact suicide attempts? A multi-method study of police calls for service. (Al Falatah, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *San Francisco Conference*. [manuscript under review]
- Spohn, R., **Al Falatah, S.**, Tostlebe, J., & Ursino, J. Sex offender treatment: An evaluation of the effectiveness of prison- and community-based programming. (Al Falatah, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *San Francisco, Conference*. [report in progress]
- Campagna, M., Ursino, J., **Al Falatah, S.**, & Gildea, B. Evaluating Violence Programming in Prison: Comparing Cognitive-Behavioral and Psycho-Educational Approaches (Campagna, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *San Francisco Conference*. [[report link](#)]
- 2023 **Al Falatah, S.**, & Hashimi, S. “The Effect of COVID-19 on Suicide Attempt Calls for Police Service” (Al Falatah, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *Philadelphia Conference*. [[Master’s Thesis](#)]
- Vietto, N., Armstrong, T., Schroll, D., & **Al Falatah, S.** “Associations Between ANS Activity and Psychopathic Traits: A Consideration of Differences in Association Across Stress Task” (Poster). The American Society of Criminology, *Philadelphia Conference*. [[article link](#)]
- Al Falatah, S.**, & Hashimi, S. “The implications of the COVID-19 pandemic on attempted suicide calls for police service” (Al Falatah, panel presenter). Suicide Research Symposium, *Virtual*
- 2022 **Al Falatah, S.**, & Hashimi, S. “The implications of the COVID-19 pandemic on police mental health calls for service” (Al Falatah, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *Atlanta Conference*
- Vietto, N., Armstrong, T., Schroll, D., & **Al Falatah, S.** “The Evaluation of Autonomic Nervous System Activity and Psychopathic Stressor Across Stress Conditions” (Vietto, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *Atlanta Conference*
- 2021 **Al Falatah, S.**, Jaynes, C., Fox, B., & Verona, E. “The Intersection of Race, Mental Health, and Disciplinary Sanctions in a Rural Jail” (Al Falatah, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *Chicago Conference*
- Vietto, N., Armstrong, T., Schroll, D., & **Al Falatah, S.** “Autonomic Nervous System Reactivity and Traits Associated with Antisocial Behavior” (Vietto, panel presenter). The American Society of Criminology, *Chicago Conference*

GUEST LECTURES

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| 2026 | Al Falatah, S. "Self-Care for Professionals." Brad Negrete's Mental Health and Criminal Justice Class (in-person) |
| 2023 | Al Falatah, S. "Legal Issues and the Death Penalty Part 1 & Part 2." Dr. Jenn Tostlebe's Survey of Correction Class (in-person) |
| | Al Falatah, S. "Health and Healthcare in Prison." Dr. Jenn Tostlebe's Survey of Correction Class (in-person) |
| 2021 | Al Falatah, S. "Micro-level Gang Theories." Dr. Sadaf Hashimi's Gangs and Gang Control Class (in-person) |

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice, *University of Nebraska at Omaha*

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| 2025 | CRIM 400 (Summer): Mental Health and the Criminal Justice System (online) |
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Graduate Teaching Assistant

Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice, *University of Nebraska at Omaha*

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| 2023 – 2024 | CRCJ 2210: Survey of Correction ; Dr. Jenn Tostlebe (in-person) |
| 2021 – 2022 | CRCJ 4450: Gangs and Gang Control ; Dr. Sadaf Hashimi (in-person) |

GRANTS AND AWARDS

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| 2025 - 2026 | Graduate Research and Creative Activity Grant, "Adverse Childhood Experiences and Brain Development in Emerging Adulthood." University of Nebraska at Omaha - \$5,000. |
| 2026 | ORCA Student Conference Travel Fund, University of Nebraska at Omaha. <i>ACJS Doctoral Summit</i> - \$500 |
| 2025 | ORCA Student Conference Travel Fund, University of Nebraska at Omaha. <i>ASC Conference</i> - \$500 <ul style="list-style-type: none">• <i>Did not attend due to the government shutdown</i> |
| 2021 - 2025 | Graduate Studies Conference Travel Grant, University of Nebraska at Omaha (\$2,500 total, \$500 per year) |
| 2021 | Undergraduate Research Scholarship, University of South Florida - \$500 |

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- 2026 Doctoral Student Summit Fellow. Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences.
 • *The summit included a scholarship*
- 2025 Digital Learning Course: Improving the Accessibility of Your Canvas Course. Completed at the University of Nebraska at Omaha. May 5, 2025.
- 2024 Digital Learning Course: Foundations of Teaching Online. Completed at the University of Nebraska at Omaha. October 25, 2024.
- 2023 Measurement Validity and Reliability: Logic and Process of Exploratory Factor Analysis. Crime and Justice Public Opinion Lab. Leah Butler, Ph.D., Teresa Kulig, Ph.D. University of Nebraska Omaha. May 5, 2023.
- Grant Writing Workshop: Breaking Down the Request for Proposals. Justin Nix, Ph.D., & Tara Richards, Ph.D. March 10, 2023.
- 2021 On Grants – Part 1. Emily Wright, Ph.D., Zachary Hamilton, Ph.D. Graduate Seminar Series. December 3, 2021.
- Navigating IRB and GRACA. Lisa Sample, Ph.D., Rachael Reif, M.A., Amber Krushas, M.A., and Nick Vietto, M.A. Graduate Seminar Series. October 29, 2021.
- Intro to The National Archive of Criminal Justice Data. A.J. Million, Ph.D. Graduate Seminar Series. October 15, 2021.

SERVICE

- 2024 – 2025 UNO School of Criminology and Criminal Justice Graduate Student Organization (GSO), President
- 2023 – 2024 UNO School of Criminology and Criminal Justice Graduate Student Organization (GSO), Secretary
- 2023 Volunteer at the Jailhouse Golf Scramble hosted by the School of Criminology and Criminal Justice

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATION

- American Society of Criminology, Student Member
- *Division of Corrections and Sentencing*
 - *Division of Health and Disability Criminology*